

THE KEYS COACH

FREE LESSON BOOK

CONNECTOR CHORDS

THEKEYSCOACH.COM

CONNECTOR CHORDS

Turn Basic Chords into Beautiful Progressions



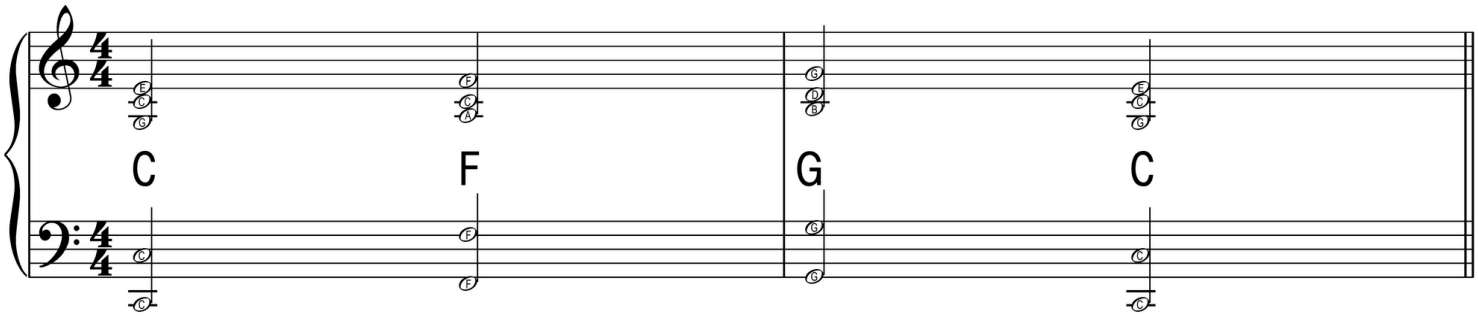
Introduction *from Adam*

This simple technique is my go-to for making chord changes feel smoother, richer and more expressive at the piano. Connector chords help to create a stronger sense of direction to almost any progression.

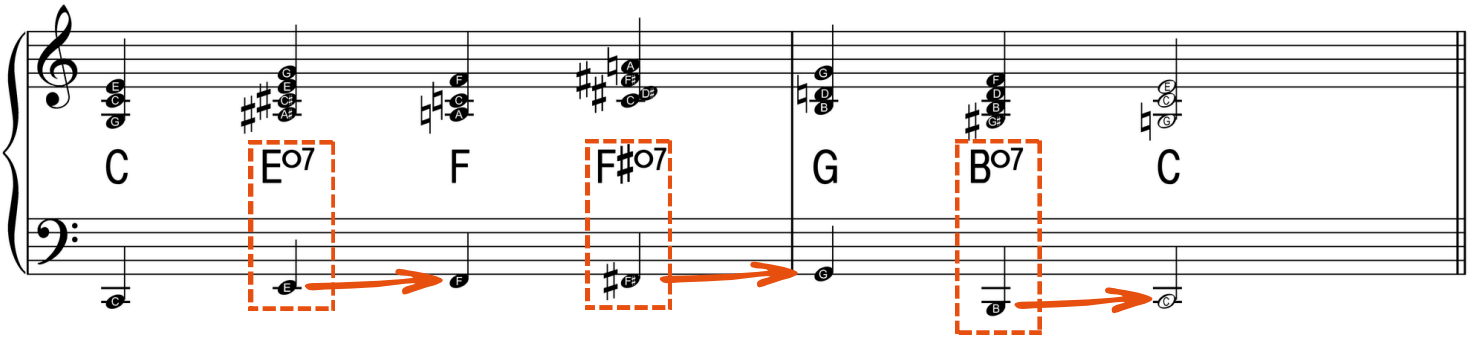
Step #1

Connecting Major Chords *video 2:10*

Play chords **I, IV and V** in the **key of C major.** In today's example, we'll use **inversions** to help each chord connect as smoothly and naturally as possible.



Add a **diminished passing chord** one **half step below** each major chord, using inversions for smooth voice leading. Hear how much **richer** the progression sounds!



Half step below each major chord!

Step #2

Connecting Minor Chords

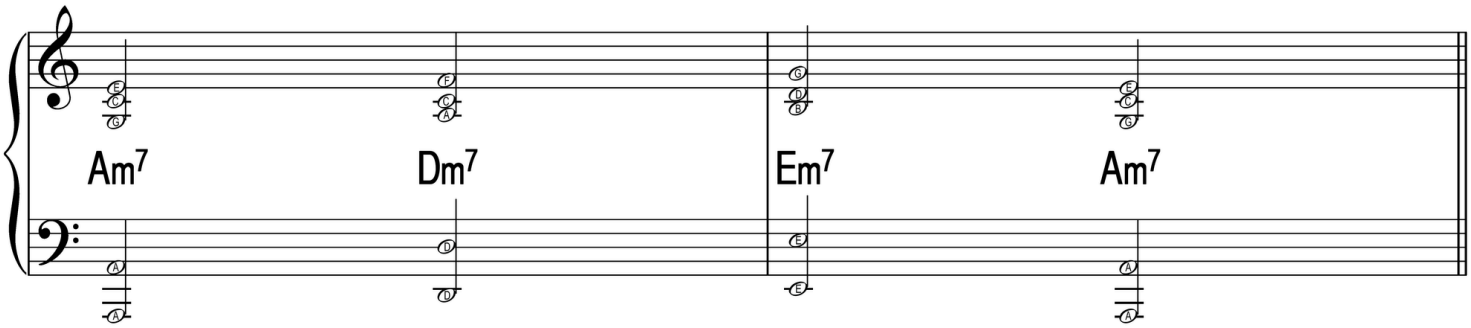
video 7:38

As with the major chords, choose the **three minor chords** in C major: **Am, Dm and Em**.

Add **sevenths** to turn them into **minor 7th chords,** then explore different **inversions** for smoother movement.

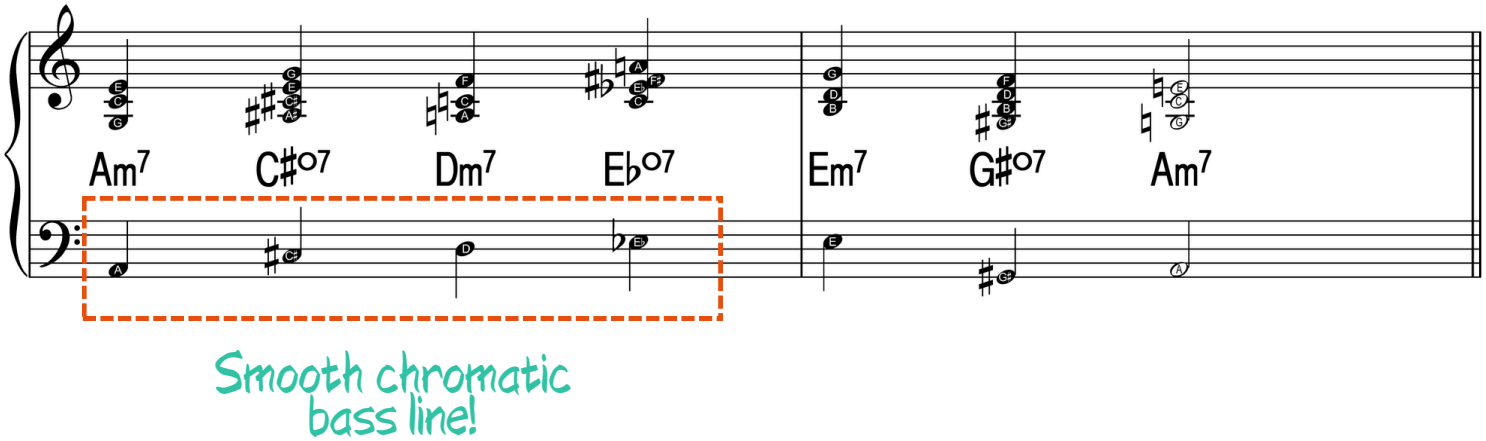


"Notice the pattern in the right hand. The major and minor chords share the same shape!"



Adding the diminished passing chord:

Follow the same process as before by adding a **diminished passing chord** one **half step below** each **minor 7th chord**. Use inversions to connect everything smoothly, and notice how full and colourful the progression sounds.



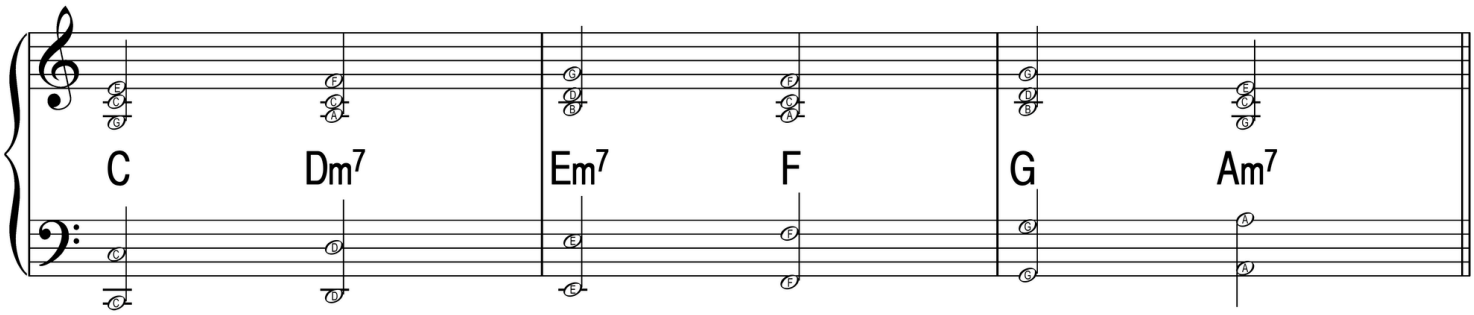
Step #3

Harmonising the Scale

video 11:45

Finally, we will bring everything together and **harmonise the C major scale.**

Start by playing the chords in order **without any passing chords.** Notice how **static** the progression sounds without that extra movement.



Now add a **diminished passing chord** one half step below each chord in the progression:



It may feel overwhelming at first, so take it **one section at a time.** This process will build **fluency in the key,** and before long, these passing chords will start slipping naturally into your playing.





Meet Your Coach

Adam Saunders



Adam is the founder of The Keys Coach, helping piano players unlock freedom, confidence, and creativity at the keys.

He is a **Professor at Trinity Laban Conservatoire, London** where he co-founded their Popular Music degree—one of the first of its kind in the UK.

He's a **published author**, international **keynote speaker**, and **professional piano player** who has performed on global stages and major TV networks.

The mission: **to help you break free from rigid, traditional methods so you can play with true *musicality*, *creativity*, and *joy*.**



